Small moves. Useful change.

One practical experiment, in six manageable steps.



NOTICE CHOOSE SHRINK PLACE PREPARE REVIEW

READ / REFLECT / TRY / REVIEW

Make it your own.

Read one module at a time. Each lesson is followed by an exercise and a worksheet. Keep the worksheets nearby when you plan your 30-day cycle.

Use observations from your own circumstances. Examples demonstrate the method; they are not promises of an outcome.

You can change or stop an experiment if it is not useful.

DIGITAL EDITION
Use a PDF reader that supports forms. Each response has room for up to 240 characters. Save a local copy after writing, close it and reopen it to check your answers.

PRINTABLE EDITION
Print at actual size. Use the white response panels as writing space. All lessons remain readable without interaction.

A useful pace
Read for 10 minutes, write a brief response, then try one action. Completion is not the same as usefulness; review both.

Your route through.

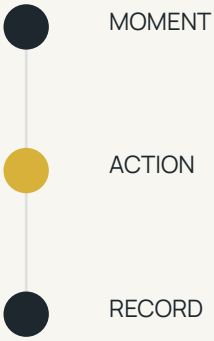
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Start with your actual day.

You do not need a new version of yourself before taking a useful step. This workbook asks you to notice one part of your day, choose what matters and test a manageable action.

The aim is a clearer experiment, not a perfect streak. You will write down a cue, a minimum action, a backup and a review date.

Keep the plan within your control. If another person or an outside condition matters, name that dependency rather than quietly treating it as your responsibility.



What would you like this cycle to help you understand?

A simple framework.



NOTICE / describe the moment



CHOOSE / name the priority



SHRINK / define the minimum



PLACE / choose a cue



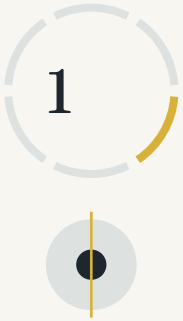
PREPARE / plan for friction



REVIEW / use the evidence

The route is deliberate. Revisit earlier steps when your record suggests a change.

Notice the pattern



MODULE 1 OF 6 / LESSON

Start with a real moment, not a judgement.

A useful change starts with something you can describe. Instead of writing “I am always distracted”, choose one recent moment: what you were doing, what interrupted it and what happened next.

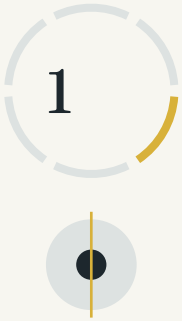
For three ordinary days, notice one repeated friction. It might be a task you keep postponing, a meeting that leaves no time to finish work, or a decision you remake each morning. Record the circumstances before choosing a solution.

Separate an observation from an interpretation. “I opened my inbox four times while writing” is an observation. “I have no discipline” is an interpretation that gives you very little to test.

You do not need a perfect diary. A short note made near the event is enough. Look for a situation you can influence, then carry one specific example into the next module.

TAKEAWAY / Describe the moment before trying to improve it.

Notice the pattern



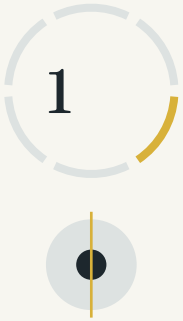
MODULE 1 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. Choose one ordinary day to examine.
2. List what happened before, during and after the friction.
3. Underline the part you can influence.

What happened? Describe the moment without labelling yourself.

What repeated circumstance is worth noticing?

Notice the pattern



MODULE 1 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

My observed pattern

One situation I can influence

What I will notice for the next three days

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Choose what matters



MODULE 2 OF 6 / LESSON

Give one priority a visible finish line.

A list can hold many important things, but a small experiment needs one priority. Choose a change that matters in your current circumstances, rather than the one that sounds most impressive.

Ask what would become easier if this change worked. A clearer start to the day might leave more attention for study. A short weekly review might reduce the number of decisions you carry into Monday.

Make the outcome observable. “Be more organised” is difficult to review. “Choose tomorrow’s first task before closing my notebook” leaves a record you can check.

Keep the experiment within your control. You can decide to prepare a question before a meeting; you cannot guarantee how someone else will respond. Name any dependency so it does not become an invisible test of your effort.

Write one priority for the next 30 days. You can return to the others later.

TAKEAWAY / One priority gives the experiment a fair chance.

Choose what matters



MODULE 2 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. Write three possible priorities.
2. Compare their usefulness and what you can influence.
3. Choose one for this cycle.

Which priority would make the clearest practical difference?

What visible evidence would show that it is helping?

Choose what matters



MODULE 2 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

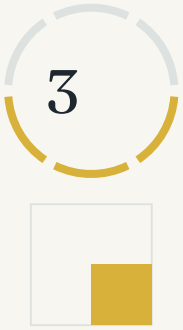
My one priority for this cycle

Why this matters now

The evidence I will look for

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Make it smaller



MODULE 3 OF 6 / LESSON

Choose a starting action you can actually repeat.

A large goal often hides several actions. Pull out the first step you can complete without waiting for the rest. The starting action should make sense on an ordinary busy day.

If your goal is to read more, the small action might be to open the book and read one paragraph. If your goal is a clearer study session, it might be to write the first problem at the top of the page.

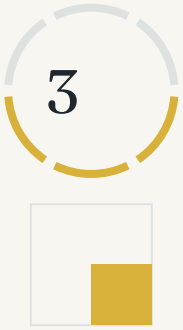
Small does not mean meaningless. The action should point towards your chosen priority. Avoid shrinking it into a gesture that has no connection to the outcome.

Define a minimum version and an optional extension. The minimum is the action you are testing. The extension is welcome when time and attention allow, but it is not a new requirement.

Try the minimum once before promising a month of it. Notice whether it needs equipment, a decision or more time than you expected.

TAKEAWAY / Test the starting action before committing to its size.

Make it smaller



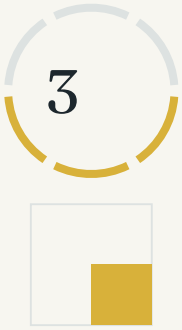
MODULE 3 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. Break your priority into its first physical action.
2. Try that action once.
3. Remove an unnecessary decision or setup step.

What is the smallest useful starting action?

What did the first trial reveal about effort or setup?

Make it smaller



MODULE 3 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

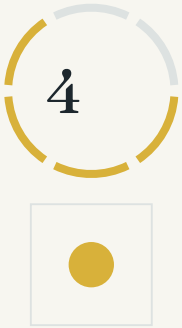
My minimum action

What counts as complete

My optional extension

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Give it a place



MODULE 4 OF 6 / LESSON

Connect the action to a moment that already exists.

An action is easier to review when you know when and where you intended to do it. Choose an existing event that happens often enough for your experiment: opening your notebook, finishing breakfast or closing your laptop.

Write the sequence plainly: “After I close my last study tab, I will write tomorrow’s first task.” The cue should be something you can recognise, rather than a vague time such as “when I have a moment”.

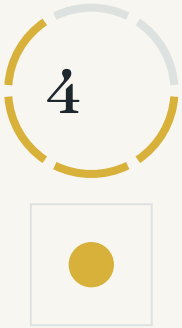
Choose a location and make the needed materials easy to find. A notebook stored where you use it can remove a small but repeated obstacle. Keep the setup proportionate; buying equipment is not a prerequisite for this workbook.

Check that your plan fits your actual week. If weekends are different, define an alternative cue rather than pretending every day has the same shape.

You are designing a testable plan, not a rule that must survive every circumstance.

TAKEAWAY / A recognisable cue makes the plan easier to test.

Give it a place



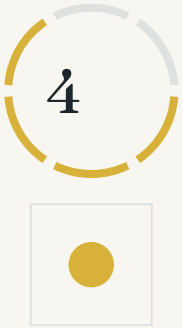
MODULE 4 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. Identify an event that already happens regularly.
2. Choose a location and prepare existing materials.
3. Write the cue-action sequence as one sentence.

Which existing moment can cue your action?

What setup would remove one small obstacle?

Give it a place



MODULE 4 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

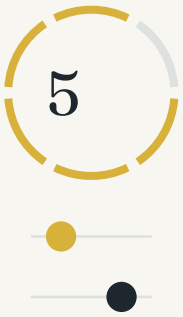
After this cue, I will...

Where the action will happen

The alternative cue for a different day

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Plan for friction



MODULE 5 OF 6 / LESSON

Decide what to do when the ordinary plan does not fit.

A useful plan includes a response to predictable friction. Consider one common interruption: a late finish, a missing notebook or a change of location. Choose a response before it happens.

An if-then sentence keeps the decision specific. “If I finish away from my desk, then I will write the task in my phone notes and copy it later.” Check that the alternative still serves the same priority.

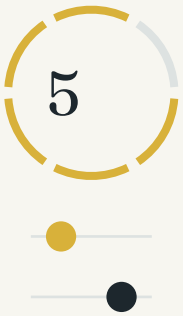
Distinguish an adjustment from abandoning the experiment. You might reduce the action, move it to a different cue or record that the day was outside your planned circumstances. None of these requires inventing a success.

When a day is missed, use the next suitable cue. Avoid adding punishment tasks to compensate; they can change the experiment into something you did not intend to test.

If the same obstacle repeats, treat it as information about the plan. The review module will help you decide what to change.

TAKEAWAY / A backup is part of the plan, not evidence of failure.

Plan for friction



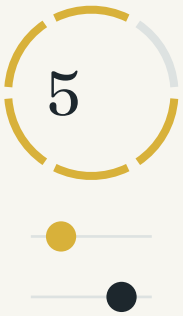
MODULE 5 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. List two predictable obstacles.
2. Choose one alternative that still serves the priority.
3. Describe a simple return after a missed day.

Which obstacle is most likely, and what is your if-then response?

What will you do at the next suitable cue after a missed day?

Plan for friction



MODULE 5 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

My predictable obstacle

My if-then alternative

My return plan

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Review and adjust



MODULE 6 OF 6 / LESSON

Use the record to decide what deserves another cycle.

At the end of the cycle, compare your record with the evidence you chose in module two. Completed days tell you about repetition; your notes tell you whether the action was useful.

Avoid turning the tracker into a score of your worth. A high count can still describe an action that did not help. A lower count may reveal a cue or minimum action that needs adjustment.

Look for patterns in the conditions. Was the action easier on certain days? Did the optional extension become an accidental requirement? Did the backup preserve the purpose when the day changed?

Choose one next step: keep the plan, adjust a specific part, or stop the experiment and choose a different priority. Write the reason in terms of what you observed.

A second cycle should contain a deliberate change, rather than a larger promise made because the first cycle was imperfect.

TAKEAWAY / Let observations guide the next version.

Review and adjust



MODULE 6 OF 6 / EXERCISE

1. Compare completed days with useful outcomes.
2. Identify one condition that helped or hindered.
3. Choose keep, adjust or stop, with a reason.

What does your record show about usefulness, not just completion?

What one part will you keep, adjust or stop?

Review and adjust



MODULE 6 OF 6 / WORKSHEET

Evidence from this cycle

My next-cycle decision and reason

The next date I will review

Keep this page with your planner. Short, specific responses are enough.

Plan the next 30 days.

Use your module worksheets to choose the minimum action. The tracker records planned opportunities, not a score of your worth.

My minimum action and cue

My start date, review date and planned opportunities

Put a tick beside days you tried the action. Record a brief note on page 25 when circumstances changed.

Track, then reflect.

30 DAYS / static grid for print, response field for digital use

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30

Digital record: list the days you tried the action

What helped, changed or needs adjustment?

A small toolkit.

Observation note

Write the time, situation, action and what happened next. Keep facts separate from interpretations. Return to module 1 on page 6.

If-then card

Keep one cue, minimum action and backup together. Use a paper card or an existing notes app. Return to module 5 on page 18.

Weekly check-in

Ask: Did I try it? Was it useful? What conditions mattered? Choose one adjustment. Return to module 6 on page 21.

These are templates in this workbook; no external account or paid tool is required.

Keep the useful part.

Take your review into the next cycle. Keep a plan that helped, adjust a part that did not fit, or choose another priority.

Clearpath is a practical workbook for defining small changes, testing useful routines and reviewing progress.

Choose your next review date on the final worksheet.



Desk reference / Laura Chouette, Unsplash.

NEXT STEP / Return to page 23, write your next-cycle decision and set the review date.

Small steps. Clearer choices.

CLEARPATH COACHING
One small shift / a practical 30-day workbook
Design and editorial production: Ayobami

NOTICE / CHOOSE / TRY / REVIEW